

Spoken Tutorial on API Basics

Module	AI Essentials
Tutorial	3. An Introduction to Building with AI
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the role of an API Key. 3. Identify components of an API Request.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• API Analogy: Restaurant Waiter • API Key • API Request
Meta Tags	API, AI, Artificial Intelligence, Prompting, API Key, API Request, Spoken Tutorial, AI Essentials, Development, Integration
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2: Introduction to Prompting. Please refer to our website for more detail

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on API Basics.
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is. • Explain the role of an API Key. • Identify components of an API Request.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should be familiar with basic prompting concepts. These are covered in Module 2: Introduction to Prompting .
Illustration showing a customer giving an order to a waiter, who takes it to the kitchen, and then brings food back to the customer, representing API communication.	What is an API ? An API is an Application Programming Interface . It helps applications communicate. Think of it like a restaurant waiter. You give your order, the waiter takes it to the kitchen. Then, the waiter brings your dish back to you. Similarly, an API acts as a messenger for your AI application. It takes your prompt to the AI model. And brings back the AI response.

Illustration showing a key icon and an ID card, representing an API Key for authorization.	Every time you visit a restaurant, you might need an ID. Similarly, an API Key identifies you to the API. It is like a secret password. This key ensures you are authorized to use the API. It also helps manage your access and usage.
Illustration showing a person placing an order, with a thought bubble containing a prompt or query, representing an API Request.	Once you have your ID, you can place your order. An API Request is like placing that order. It is how you send instructions to the AI model. Your request includes your API Key for authentication. It also contains your specific prompt or query. The API delivers this to the model for processing.
Screen close-up: user interacting with a food delivery app on a smartphone, showing restaurant and order placement.	Let's see how this works in real life. Open any food delivery app on your phone. Tap on a restaurant and select your dish. Then, tap to place your order. Behind the scenes, the app sends a request to the API. The API communicates with the restaurant's system. It places your order and fetches updates. You then see the order status on your screen. This is an API in action!
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined APIs as messengers. We understood API Keys as identifiers. We explored API Requests to communicate with AI models.
Assignment Slide	Now, for an assignment, think of another everyday service and identify its API. Compare the results.
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